

(F)

→ Belief in modern economic models to apply to primitive societies

→ Assumptions

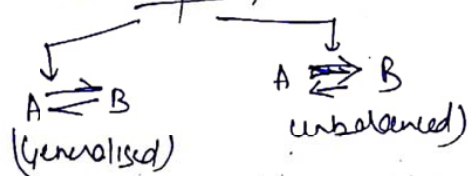
- ① Principle of utility maximization under scarce means
- ② Principle of diminishing marginal utility
- ③ Human beings have infinite needs and always seek to gain profit for self.

(S)

Concept of EMBEDDEDNESS
i.e. Economy is embedded in social and kinship based matrix

Primitive societies have economy guided by

① Reciprocity



- ② Redistribution
- ③ Primitive markets based on barter
- ④ Ceremonial exchange

CASE

① Robert Carneiro studied Bushmen (Africa) to find that they work ~3-4 hrs per day despite earning less than their potential. He concluded that their economic principles are guided by social unity and order in kinship.

⑪ Kula Exchange (Malinowski) where tribe members undertake dangerous voyages without any economic gain

⑫ Chenar tribes don't kill female animals due to fear of their female deity GARELSANA. Also, even during food shortage, a portion is given to deity

CRITICISM

① Functionalists

- Sartre noted that "tribes are optimisers and not maximisers" and said money is of no significance to most primitive societies
- prevalence of Barter system among many tribes

↳ Kurumba ← TODA ↔ Beta

② SUBSTANTIVISTS

- Plattner criticised that today, no society is completely primitive and conditions of resource scarcity exist everywhere.

→ Due to penetration of money economy, many tribes are directly participating in monetary exchanges

e.g.] Bandas sell NFTs in weekly baskets

As an opposition to two schools, Goddard and Tony propounded the MARXIST school of economic exchange

Paul and Laura Boharan, during their study of Tiv (Nigeria) noted that there is a shift towards formalism due to rising globalization

Today, the debate has lost its prominence due to an integrated approach. Anastya Sen's 'welfare economics' can be of help to understand primitive economy.

Marks:

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Intro:

Body:

Conclusion:

Total: